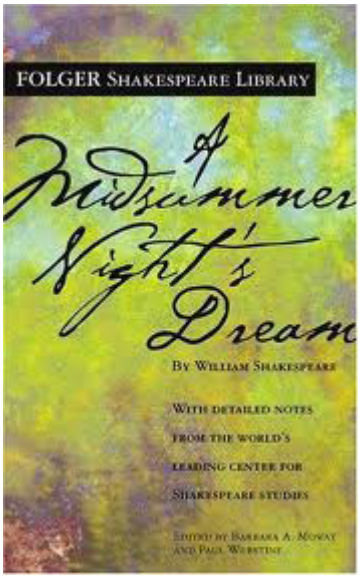
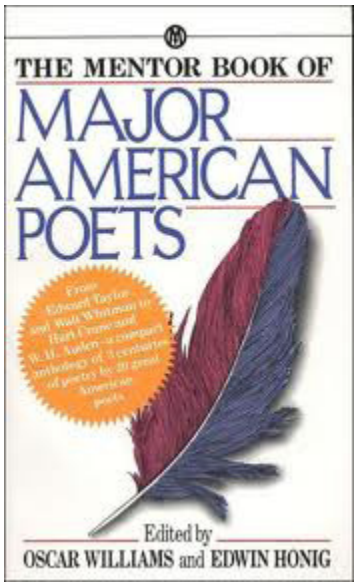
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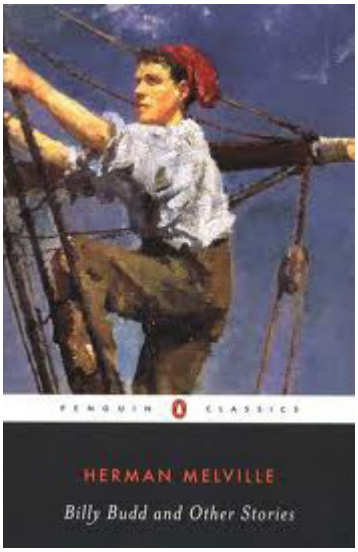
Making a World of Difference

Literary Criticism

Invitational B • 2012







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University Interscholastic League
Literary Criticism Contest • Invitational B • 2012

Part 1: Knowledge of Literary Terms and of Literary History **30 items (1 point each)**

1. The common English verse triple-syllable foot consisting of two unaccented syllables followed by one accented syllable is the

   A) anapest.
   B) antibacchius.
   C) dactyl.
   D) iamb.
   E) pyrrhic.

2. The poet whose *Collected Poems*, which includes "The Frigate Pelican," "In This Age of Hard Trying, Nonchalance Is Good and," and "The Pangolin," garnered her the 1952 Pulitzer Prize for Poetry is

   A) Elizabeth Bishop.
   B) Rita Dove.
   C) Marianne Moore.
   D) Sylvia Plath.
   E) Anne Sexton.

3. A brief subjective poem strongly marked by imagination, melody, and emotion, and creating a single unified impression is a

   A) limerick.
   B) lyric.
   C) ode.
   D) sonnet.
   E) tanka.

4. The analysis, study, and evaluation of individual works of art, as well as the formulation of general principles for the examination of such works, is

   A) annotation.
   B) criticism.
   C) exegesis.
   D) flosculation.
   E) scansion.

5. A recurrent grouping, or division, of two or more verse lines in terms of length, metrical form, and often, rhyme scheme (or thought) is known as a

   A) ballad.
   B) couplet.
   C) pantun.
   D) rondeau.
   E) stanza.

6. The literary trope that can be used to heighten effect, including humorous effect, through exaggeration is

   A) animism.
   B) gigantism.
   C) hyperbole.
   D) litotes.
   E) understatement.

7. The American novelist who was awarded the 1962 Nobel Prize for Literature, the author of *The Pearl*, *Cannery Row*, *Of Mice and Men*, *In Dubious Battle*, and *The Grapes of Wrath*, is

   A) William Faulkner.
   B) Sinclair Lewis.
   C) Toni Morrison.
   D) Eugene O'Neill.
   E) John Steinbeck.

8. **Not** among the English-language poets readily associated with the legends of King Arthur and his knights is

   A) Thomas Malory.
   B) Edmund Spenser.
   C) Alfred, Lord Tennyson.
   D) E. B. White.
   E) T. H. White.

9. The period of American literature in which Anne Bradstreet, Benjamin Franklin, and Jonathan Edwards flourished as authors is called the

   A) Colonial Period.
   B) Postmodern Period.
   C) Realistic Period.
   D) Revolutionary and Early National Period.
   E) Romantic Period.

10. The continuation of sense and grammatical construction of one line on to the next verse or couplet is

    A) enjambment.
    B) fused rhyme.
    C) run-on line.
    D) tag-line.
    E) truncation.

11. The period in British literature between the death of Queen Victoria and the beginning of the first World War is the

A) Augustan Age.
B) Caroline Age.
C) Edwardian Age.
D) Jacobean Age.
E) Victorian Age.

12. The name for the early phase of medieval religious drama when the mystery plays were performed as part or extension of a church service is

A) epistolary literature.
B) liturgical drama.
C) pantomime.
D) pastoral drama.
E) verse drama.

13. The genre of formal poems exhibiting a variety of methods, moods, and subjects, all of which offer a meditation on death or another solemn theme, is the

A) elegy.
B) encomium.
C) eulogy.
D) paean.
E) threnody.

14. The word meaning 'rebirth' and commonly applied to the period of transition from the medieval to the modern world in Europe and which was marked by an attempt to harmonize a Christian tradition with an older classical pagan tradition is

A) Classicism.
B) Feudalism.
C) Historicism.
D) Renaissance.
E) Restoration.

15. Authors, including James Fenimore Cooper, Bret Harte, Mark Twain, Horace Greeley, Hamlin Garland, Larry McMurtry, and Cormic McCarthy, whose writings address life in the United States during westward expansion are contributors to the genre known as

A) Frontier Literature.
B) Local Color Writing.
C) metafiction.
D) Native American Literature.
E) Popular Literature.

16. **Not** to be found among the names on a passenger list of a hypothetical fishing trip during the decades prior to the American Civil War is

A) James Fenimore Cooper.
B) Nathaniel Hawthorne.
C) Ernest Hemingway.
D) Herman Melville.
E) Edgar Allan Poe.

17. Rhyme that falls on the stressed, concluding syllables of the rhyme words, the most common English-language rhyme, is known as

A) beginning rhyme.
B) feminine rhyme.
C) internal rhyme.
D) masculine rhyme.
E) triple rhyme.

18. The author of nineteenth-century British realistic novels, including *Adam Bede*, *The Mill on the Floss*, *Silas Marner*, and *Middlemarch*, is

A) Charles Dickens.
B) George Eliot.
C) Walter Scott.
D) Robert Louis Stevenson.
E) William Makepeace Thackeray.

19. The twentieth-century American author who, along with Hemingway, Cummings, and Sherwood Anderson, formulated a symbolistic style, a style that characterized his novels, including *The Great Gatsby* and *Tender Is the Night*, is

A) William Faulkner.
B) F. Scott Fitzgerald.
C) Joseph Heller.
D) Ernst Hemingway.
E) John Steinbeck.

20. A chronicle, usually autobiographical, presenting the life story of a rascal of low degree engaged in menial tasks and making his living more through his wit than his industry, and tending to be episodic and structureless, is known as a(n)

A) epistolary novel.
B) novel of character.
C) novel of manners.
D) novel of the soil.
E) picaresque novel.

21. The group of eighteenth-century poets who wrote poems on death and immortality that attempted to establish an atmosphere of pleasing gloom in order to call up the horrors of death through the imagery of the charnel house is the

A) Graveyard School.
B) Kailyard School.
C) Lake School.
D) Satanic School.
E) Spasmodic School.

22. **Not** a figure of speech that somehow ascribes to animals, ideas, abstractions, or inanimate objects with characteristics not inherently their own is

A) anthropomorphism.
B) humanism.
C) personification.
D) pathetic fallacy.
E) reification.

23. The group of American writers of the 1950s and the 1960s in rebellion against what they conceived of as the failures of American culture—and whose most iconic representative is Jack Kerouac—is the

A) Agrarians.
B) Angry Young Men.
C) Beat Generation.
D) Lollards.
E) Muckrakers.

24. A movement that developed in England during the sixteenth century and later spread its influence into the New England colonies, leaving its impress and attitudes on the habits and thoughts on the people of North America, is

A) Agrarianism.
B) Darwinism.
C) Naturalism.
D) Puritanism.
E) Transcendentalism.

25. The philosophy founded by Zeno in the fourth century BCE that exalts endurance and self-sufficiency and that, in Hemingway's words, can be recognized as "grace under pressure" is

A) Calvinism.
B) Gnosticism.
C) Humanism.
D) Philistinism.
E) Stoicism.

26. The first English translation of Boethius' *Consolation of Philosophy*, the first history of the English people, the Venerable Bede's *Ecclesiastical History*, and the flourishing of the School of Cædmon represent the

A) Augustan Age.
B) Early Victorian Age.
C) Elizabethan Age.
D) Late Victorian Age.
E) Old English Period.

27. A rhyme in which the rhyming stressed syllables are followed by an undifferentiated identical unstressed syllable is known as

A) blank verse.
B) feminine rhyme.
C) heteronymous rhyme.
D) leonine rhyme.
E) *rime riche*.

28. The author of *The Neon Bible* and recipient of the 1981 Pulitzer Prize for Fiction, which was awarded posthumously, for his brilliant 1969 *A Confederacy of Dunces* is

A) Norman Mailer.
B) Cormac McCarthy.
C) Philip Roth.
D) John Kennedy Toole.
E) John Updike.

29. An anonymous narrative that presents supernatural episodes as a means of interpreting natural events, making concrete and particular a special perception of human beings or a cosmic view, is called a(n)

A) *chanson de geste*.
B) epic.
C) hagiography.
D) legend.
E) myth.

30. The author of the screenplay for the award-winning movie *Tender Mercies* and recipient of the 1995 Pulitzer Prize for Drama for *The Young Man from Atlanta* is

A) Edward Albee.
B) Horton Foote.
C) David Mamet.
D) Sam Shepard.
E) August Wilson.

Part 2: The UIL Reading List **20 items (2 points each)**

Items 31-37 are associated with William Shakespeare's *A Midsummer Night's Dream*.
Items 38-45 are associated with Herman Melville's *Billy Budd, Sailor, An Inside Narrative*.
Items 46-50 are associated with Marianne Moore's poetry (selected).

31. In Shakespeare's *Midsummer Night's Dream*, the character not somehow paired with a lover is
    A) Demetrius.
    B) Egeus.
    C) Helena.
    D) Hermia.
    E) Lysander.

32. In lamenting an absence, one of the mechanicals notes that one of their company "Hath simply the best wit of any handicraftsman in Athens"; this compliment is paid to
    A) Bottom.
    B) Flute.
    C) Quince.
    D) Snout.
    E) Starveling.

33. The exchange "For I am sick when I do look on thee. / And I am sick when I look not on you" occurs between
    A) Demetrius and Helena.
    B) Demetrius and Hermia.
    C) Hermia and Helena.
    D) Lysander and Helena.
    E) Lysander and Hermia.

34. The character who describes him- or herself as "that merry wanderer of the night" is
    A) Hippolyta.
    B) Oberon.
    C) Quince.
    D) Robin.
    E) Titania.

35. Lysander's plan to escape Athens's tyranny is timed for "Tomorrow night when Phoebe doth behold / Her silver visage in the wat'ry glass [. . .]"; Phoebe is
    A) the changeling.
    B) the maidservant.
    C) the moon.
    D) the nightingale.
    E) the water sprite.

36. Theseus' describing the play about the youthful Pyramus and Thisbe as "tragical mirth" is
    A) euphemistic.
    B) euphonic.
    C) hyperbolic.
    D) onomatopoeic.
    E) oxymoronic.

37. "You juggler, you cankerblossom, / You thief of love! What, have you come by night / And stol'n my love's heart from him?" are words of accusation spoken by
    A) Helena to Hermia.
    B) Hermia to Helena.
    C) Hippolyta to Theseus.
    D) Theseus to Hippolyta.
    E) Titania to Oberon.

38. The ship from which Billy is impressed in Melville's *Billy Budd* is named after a book written by
    A) Edmund Burke.
    B) Denis Diderot.
    C) Stephen Girard.
    D) Thomas Paine.
    E) Voltaire.

39. "Do you come to me [. . .] with so foggy a tale?" is the question that reflects
    A) Claggart's estimation of Billy's explanation.
    B) the Dansker's reply to Billy's explanation.
    C) the narrator's description of the Nore uprising.
    D) the narrator's description of the Spithead mutiny.
    E) Vere's assessment of Claggart's accusation.

40. The simile "wars which like the flight of harpies rose shrieking from the din and the dust of the fallen Bastille" relies on an allusion to the
    A) American Civil War.
    B) American Revolutionary War.
    C) Boer Wars.
    D) English Civil War.
    E) French Revolution.

41. The one word that Melville's narrator suggests is avoided while talking about naval business is

A) coxswain.
B) jewel-block.
C) mutiny.
D) rights.
E) scurvy.

42. The crew member responsible for giving Billy the "name by which the foretopman eventually became known aboard the ship" is

A) Albert.
B) the Dansker.
C) Jimmy Legs.
D) Red Pepper.
E) Squeak.

43. The captain of the HMS *Bellipotent 74* is

A) Claggart.
B) Girard.
C) Nelson.
D) Vere.
E) Wellington.

44. "But let not warm hearts betray heads that should be cool" is Vere's reminder to the drumhead court that

A) foretopmen are emotional sailors.
B) hearts often bleed when the head is hit hard.
C) mutiny involves both the heart and the head.
D) naval officers must be empathetic.
E) reason should prevail over emotion.

45. The French ship with which the *Bellipotent* is engaged in battle when Vere is wounded is the

A) *Athée*.
B) *Erebus*.
C) *Monitor*.
D) *Theseus*.
E) *Victory*.

Items 46-47 refer to Marianne Moore's

Fish

wade
through black jade.
Of the crow-blue mussel-shells, one keeps
adjusting the ash-heaps;
opening and shutting itself like an
injured fan.
The barnacles which encrust the side
of the wave, cannot hide
there for the submerged shafts of the sun,
split like spun
glass, move themselves with spotlight swiftness into the crevices—
in and out, illuminating the
turquoise sea
of bodies. The water drives a wedge
of iron through the iron edge
of the cliff; whereupon the stars, pink
rice-grains, ink-
bespattered jelly fish, crabs like green
lilies, and submarine
toadstools, slide each on the other. All
external
marks of abuse are present on this
defiant edifice—
all the physical features of ac-
cident—lack
of cornice, dynamite grooves, burns, and
hatchet strokes, these things stand
out on it; the chasm-side is dead.
Repeated
evidence has proved that it can live
on what can not revive
its youth. The sea grows old in it.

46. The central subject of Marianne Moore's "The Fish," is the

A) barnacles.
B) cliff.
C) dead.
D) fish.
E) toadstools.

47. Moore's poem is a good example of

A) echo verse.
B) free verse.
C) nonsense verse.
D) skeltonic verse.
E) syllabic verse.

Items 48-50 refer to Marianne Moore's

In the Days of Prismatic Colour

not in the days of Adam and Eve but when Adam
was alone; when there was no smoke and colour was
fine, not with the refinement
of early civilization art but because
of its originality, with nothing to modify it but the

mist that went up, obliqueness was a varia-
tion of the perpendicular, plain to see and
to account for: it is no
longer that; nor did the blue-red-yellow band
of incandescence that was colour, keep its stripe: it also
is one of

those things into which much that is peculiar can be
read; complexity is not a crime but carry
it to the point of murki-
ness and nothing is plain. Complexity,
moreover, that has been committed to darkness, instead of
granting it—

self to be the pestilence that it is, moves all a-
bout as if to bewilder with the dismal
fallacy that insistence
is the measure of achievement and that all
truth must be dark. Principally throat, sophistication is
as it al-

ways has been—at the antipodes from the init-
ial great truths. "Part of it was crawling, part of it
was about to crawl, the rest
was torpid in its lair." In the short legged, fit-
ful advance, the gurgling and all the minutiae we have
the classic

multitude of feet. To what purpose! Truth is no Apollo
Belvedere, no formal thing. The wave may go over it if
it likes.
Know that it will be there when it says.
"I shall be there when the wave has gone by."

48. Moore's poem "In the Days of Prismatic Colour" is a critical denunciation of

A) Apollo Belveder.
B) colour.
C) complexity.
D) originality.
E) perpendicularity.

49. Moore's source for the quoted passage, "Part of it was crawling, part of it was about to crawl, the rest was torpid in its lair," is

A) Archimedes of Syracuse.
B) Demosthenes of Athens.
C) Nestor of Laranda.
D) Pyramus of Thisbe.
E) Theseus of Athens.

50. Moore's poem argues that among the things—like the prismatic colours—that endure, are the

A) antipodes. (line 21)
B) days of Adam and Eve. (line 1)
C) gurgling and the minutiae. (line 24)
D) initial great truths. (lines 21-22)
E) smoke and colour. (line 2)

Part 3: Ability in Literary Criticism
15 items (2 points each)

Items 51-53 refer to John Clare's

The Flight of Birds

The crow goes flopping on from wood to wood,
The wild duck wherries to the distant flood,
The starnels hurry o'er in merry crowds,
And overhead whew by like hasty clouds;
The wild duck from the meadow-water plies
And dashes up the water as he flies;
The pigeon suthers by on rapid wing,
The lark mounts upward at the call of spring.
In easy flights above the hurricane
With doubled neck high sails the noisy crane.
Whizz goes the pewit o'er the ploughman's team,
With many a whew and whirl and sudden scream;
And lightly fluttering to the tree just by,
In chattering journeys whirls the noisy pie;
From bush to bush slow swees the screaming jay,
With one harsh note of pleasure all the day.

51. The imagery that John Clare uses to present the flying of various birds in his poem "The Flight of Birds" is principally

A) auditory.
B) gustatory.
C) olfactory.
D) tactile.
E) visual.

52. John Clare's sixteen-line lyrical tribute to the flight of birds is constructed of

A) alcaics.
B) blank verse.
C) bobs and wheels.
D) couplets.
E) distiches.

53. The basic metrical pattern characterizing Clare's poem is

A) anapestic heptameter.
B) dactylic trimeter.
C) iambic pentameter.
D) ionic hexameter.
E) trochaic tetrameter.

Items 54-60 refer to D. H. Lawrence's

Piano

Softly, in the dusk, a woman is singing to me;
Taking me back down the vista of years, till I see
A child sitting under the piano, in the boom of the tingling strings
And pressing the small, poised feet of a mother who smiles as she sings.

In spite of myself, the insidious mastery of song
Betrays me back, till the heart of me weeps to belong
To the old Sunday evenings at home, with winter outside
And hymns in the cosy parlour, the tinkling piano our guide.

So now it is vain for the singer to burst into clamour
With the great black piano appassionato. The glamour
Of childish days is upon me, my manhood is cast
Down in the flood of remembrance, I weep like a child for the past.

54. The rhyme scheme of D. H. Lawrence's lyric poem "Piano" is

A) *aabbccddeeff*.
B) *ababcdcdefef*.
C) *abbacddceffe*.
D) *baabdccdfeef*.
E) *feceddabbacf*.

55. The marked use of sibilant sounds throughout the poem, especially in the second stanza, is

A) anaphora.
B) assonance.
C) cacophony.
D) dissonance.
E) sigmatism

56. Lawrence's use of *insidious* and *betray* in the second stanza, contribute to the poem's

A) brevity.
B) length.
C) provincialism.
D) tone.
E) symbolism.

57. Thematically, the poem highlights the often two-sided experience of

A) childhood.
B) piano playing.
C) remembering.
D) singing.
E) weeping.

58. The sound device that contributes to the sensory power of the poem, especially that of lines 3, 8, and 9, is

A) alliteration.
B) cacophony.
C) euphony.
D) onomatopoeia.
E) syncopation.

Item 59 refers to Katie Mallett's

Beauty of Japan
Reduced by Western parlance
To banality.

59. The poetic form represented by Mallett's three lines is the

A) haiku.
B) katauta.
C) lai.
D) senryu.
E) tanka.

Items 60-65 refer to Gerard Manley Hopkins's

Felix Randal

Felix Randal the farrier,* O he is dead then? my duty all ended,
Who have watched his mould of man, big-boned and hardy-handsome
Pining,* pining, till time when reason rambled in it and some
Fatal four disorders, fleshed there, all contended?

Sickness broke him. Impatient he cursed at first, but mended
Being anointed* and all; though a heavenlier heart began some
Months earlier, since I had our sweet reprieve and ransom
Tendered to him. Ah well, God rest him all road* ever he offended!

This seeing the sick endears them to us, us too it endears.
My tongue had taught thee comfort, touch had quenched thy tears,
Thy tears that touched my heart, child, Felix, poor Felix Randal;

How far from then forethought of, all thy more boisterous years,
When thou at the random grim forge, powerful amidst peers,
Didst fettle* for the great grey drayhorse* his bright and battering sandal!

*blacksmith
*yearning
*last rites
*any way
*prepare
*horse used to pull a funeral wagon

60. The persona speaking in Hopkins's "Felix Randal" is a
A) blacksmith.
B) child.
C) drayhorse.
D) farrier.
E) priest.

61. The rhyme scheme suggests that the poem should be considered a
A) ballad.
B) fourteener.
C) quatrain.
D) sonnet.
E) *terza rima*.

62. The ordering of the words in a line of poetry to accommodate rhyme and rhythm that so characterizes Hopkins's poem, especially lines 12-14 is known as
A) accentualism.
B) enjambment.
C) inversion.
D) ornamentalism.
E) uchronia.

63. The "sweet reprieve and ransom / Tendered to" Felix Randal is
A) death.
B) forgiveness.
C) health.
D) money.
E) sickness.

64. The dominant auditory scheme, or melopoetic, gracing Hopkins's poem is
A) alliteration.
B) assonance.
C) consonance.
D) onomatopoeia.
E) sibilance.

65. Lines 2, 3, 4, 5, 7, 10, 12, and 14 of Hopkins's "Felix Randal" feature no fewer than nine instances of
A) beginning rhyme.
B) feminine rhyme.
C) internal rhyme.
D) leonine rhyme.
E) *rime riche*.

Tie-breaking essay prompt on the next page.

Part 4: Tie-Breaking Essay (required)

Note well: Contestants who do not write an essay will be disqualified even if they are not involved in any tie.

Note well: Any essay that does not demonstrate a sincere effort to discuss the assigned topic will be disqualified. The judge(s) should note carefully this criterion when breaking ties: ranking of essays for tie-breaking purposes should be based primarily on how well the topic has been addressed.

Three sheets of paper have been provided for this essay; your written response should reflect the *Handbook*'s notion that an essay is a "moderately brief discussion of a restricted topic": something more than just a few sentences.

Read Sir Thomas More's sixteenth-century appreciation for the herb rosmarine (rosemary) and Marianne Moore's poem "Rosemary." Draw a comparison or contrast between Thomas More's categorizing of rosemary as the "herb sacred to remembrance" and Marianne Moore's describing rosemary "as symbol and as pungency," both of which are significant to the act of remembering.

As for Rosmarine, I let it run all over my garden walls, not only because my bees love it, but because it is the herb sacred to remembrance, and, therefore, to friendship; whence a sprig of it hath a dumb* language that maketh it the chosen emblem of our funeral wakes and in our burial grounds.

Sir Thomas More

***lacking the power of speech**

Rosemary

Beauty and Beauty's son and rosemary—
Venus and Love, her son, to speak plainly—
born of the sea supposedly,
at Christmas each, in company,
braids a garland of festivity.
Not always rosemary—

since the flight to Egypt, blooming indifferently.
With lancelike leaf, green but silver underneath,
its flowers—white originally—
turned blue. The herb of memory,
imitating the blue robe of Mary,
is not too legendary

to flower both as symbol and as pungency.*
Springing from stones beside the sea,
the height of Christ when he was thirty-three,
it feeds on dew and to the bee
"hath a dumb language"; is in reality
a kind of Christmas tree.

Marianne Moore

***sharply strong smell**

University Interscholastic League
Literary Criticism Contest
Invitational B • 2012
KEY

Page numbers are those associated with the *Handbook* 11e, the Penguin 1986 edition of *Budd*, and the Folger edition of *MND*.

Part 1: Knowledge of Literary Terms and of Literary History **30 items (1 point each)**

1.	A	26	11.	C	188	21.	A	255
2.	C	662	12.	B	319	22.	B	276
3.	B	324	13.	A	190	23.	C	59
4.	B	133	14.	D	466	24.	D	448
5.	E	525	15.	A	243	25.	E	527
6.	C	279	16.	C		26.	E	198, 382
7.	E	658	17.	D	333	27.	B	236
8.	D		18.	B	624	28.	D	661
9.	A	111	19.	B	363	29.	E	358
10.	A	199	20.	E	416	30.	B	665

Part 2: UIL Reading List **20 items (2 points each)**

31.	B		38.	D	297	45.	A	381
32.	A	4.2.9-10	39.	E	346	46.	B	
33.	A	2.1.219-20	40.	E	316	47.	E	537
34.	D	2.1.45	41.	C	368, 357	48.	C	
35.	C	1.1.213-15	42.	B	320	49.	C	
36.	E	5.1.61	43.	D		50.	D	
37.	B	3.2.296-98	44.	E	362			

Part 3: Ability in Literary Criticism **15 items (2 points each)**

51.	A		56.	D	553	61.	D	
52.	D	129	57.	C		62.	C	
53.	C		58.	D	384	63.	B	
54.	A		59.	A	259	64.	A	
55.	E	513	60.	E		65.	C	294

Part 4: Tie-Breaking Essay

These notes are not intended to be understood as a key for the Tie-Breaking Essay prompt; rather, they should serve the judge(s) as a presentation of critical ideas that might appear in an essay responding to the prompt.

Criteria for judging the Tie-Breaking Essay **SHOULD** include

the degree to which the instructions have been followed,

the quality of the critical insight offered in response to the selection,

the overall effectiveness of the written discussion, and

the grammatical correctness of the essay.

Note well that the quality of the contestant's critical insight is more important than the contestant's prose style. In short, the Literary Criticism contest is one that promotes the critical analysis of literature. The quality of the writing, which should never go unappreciated, does not trump evidence of critical analysis.

Critical Notes on Marianne Moore's "Rosemary" and Thomas More's "Rosmarine"

Literary concepts that MIGHT be used by the contestant in a discussion of these poems include

alliteration,
allusion,
myth,
mythopoeia,
personification,
reification,
rhyme,
theme, and
tone.

The young writer in comparing More's prose to Moore's poem should recognize that rosemary has been treated as a traditional symbol of remembrance by at least two writers, which should suggest something in the way of a cultural universality. That Marianne Moore directly quotes Thomas More ("hath a dumb language") might be seen as important in and of itself, but the connection should not be overemphasized or serve as the focus of the contestant's response.

The natural beauty of More's rosmarine and its attraction to the bees in his garden—the dumb language—is fleshed out in the Roman mythological figures of Venus and Cupid, then tied into the Christian story of the nativity and ultimate sacrifice, and is then remembered in the unmentioned pungency of the pagan [kind of] Christmas tree.

Colors, both implicitly presented (More's green and black) and enumerated (Moore's green, silver, white, and blue) might be the foundation of a comparison that contrasts More's remembrance-herb, which is focused on the physical, perhaps mortal, world (the garden, the bees, death, and burial) with Moore's "herb of memory," which is focused on the promise(s) of the spiritual world (the god and goddess of beauty and love, respectively), of escape (Egypt), of salvation (Christ), and a symbol of commemoration ("a kind of Christmas tree")—encompassing love, beauty, and salvation.

The contestant might well recognize More's connecting the herb to funeral wakes and burial and Moore's connecting rosemary with a specific (implied) death and burial as an indication of the symbolic importance of the herb, even across time and in differing contexts.